

A PRINTABLE ACTION KIT FOR FAMILIES WITH CHILDREN AGES 6-12

# The 7-Day School-Night Screen Reset

A practical family kit for clearer device boundaries, more predictable transitions, and a plan you can actually repeat

START IN 10 MINUTES



Printable A4 edition • Personal household use

# Your ten-minute start

The hardest part is rarely deciding that screens need a boundary. It is holding that boundary at 7:42 p.m., when everyone is tired. Do not rebuild the whole household tonight. Make one decision.

## 1 Pick one moment

Choose the point that causes the most friction: homework, dinner, the final game, or bedtime.

## 2 Write one visible rule

Use a sentence a child could repeat. Example: Recreational screens park at 7:30 on school nights.

## 3 Give a five-minute warning

Say what will happen next, not what the child did wrong.

## 4 Offer two off-screen choices

Keep both choices acceptable to you. A choice is not a negotiation about the boundary.

### SAY THIS

*"Five minutes left. When the timer ends, the device parks here. Then you can choose a snack with me or Lego at the table."*

### TONIGHT

**Write tonight's single boundary on a sticky note and place it where the device will park.**

# One boundary. Seven nights. Real information.

This kit is a short experiment, not a verdict on your parenting. You will choose one school-night boundary, test it for seven nights, and adjust the setup instead of changing the rule in the middle of a hard moment.

- ☐ Use the daily pages in order. Each night adds one small skill.
- ☐ Separate recreational use from homework, communication, accessibility, and creative work.
- ☐ Keep the boundary stable. Adjust the warning, location, replacement, or timing when needed.
- ☐ If two caregivers disagree, settle the adult plan before asking a child to follow it.
- ☐ A difficult night is data. Repair, reset, and continue without adding a bigger punishment.

## What this kit does not do

It does not diagnose screen addiction, prescribe a universal number of daily hours, or promise changes in sleep, grades, mood, or behavior. Those outcomes depend on more than a printable plan.

## TONIGHT

**Circle the one outcome you control: a clear rule, a predictable warning, a consistent location, or a calmer response.**

# Notice before you change

Think about the last three school nights. Estimate honestly. Precision is less useful than a pattern you can see.

Recreational screen use usually begins at:

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The hardest device to stop is:

---

The hardest moment is usually:

---

The first warning usually happens at:

---

What happens immediately after the device turns off?

---

What do adults usually say or do next?

---

What is the friction mostly about?

☐ The ending feels sudden

☐ The next activity is unclear

☐ The rule changes by day

☐ Adults disagree

☐ The child is hungry or tired

☐ The content has no natural stopping point

## TONIGHT

Choose the friction you can change without demanding that your child feel differently.

# Find the transition, not the villain

Conflict often sits between two activities. Map the hour around your hardest moment. Include what the adults are doing, too.

|                             | 60 min before | 30 min before | 10 min before | Screen ends | 10 min after |
|-----------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|-------------|--------------|
| What is happening?          |               |               |               |             |              |
| What does the child expect? |               |               |               |             |              |
| What does the adult expect? |               |               |               |             |              |

**Look for a missing bridge**

A bridge can be a timer, a saved stopping point, a snack, a shower already prepared, music, a short connection ritual, or a task broken into a first tiny step.

**TONIGHT**

**Add one bridge before the screen ends. Do not wait until the device is already in someone's hand.**

# Write a rule a child can repeat

A usable rule answers four questions: which screens, on which nights, when they stop, and where they go.

On [nights], [recreational screens] stop at [time or event] and park at [location].

Which nights does the rule cover?

---

Which uses are included? Which necessary uses are excluded?

---

What is the exact endpoint: clock time, episode, round, or event?

---

Where will devices charge or park?

---

Who follows the rule, including adults?

---

Example: On Sunday through Thursday, games and videos stop at 7:30 and devices charge in the kitchen.

Example: On school nights, the current round is the last round after the 7:15 warning. The console rests at 7:30.

TONIGHT

Read the rule aloud. If it needs a second sentence to explain, simplify it.

# Plan what comes after the screen

Stopping is easier when the next ten minutes are already decided. Pick options that fit your real energy, space, weather, and budget.

## 5 minutes

- ☐ Choose tomorrow's clothes
- ☐ Water a plant
- ☐ One-song dance
- ☐ Feed or brush a pet
- ☐ Pack the school bag
- ☐ Make a tiny snack

## 15 minutes

- ☐ Draw a comic strip
- ☐ Build one Lego challenge
- ☐ Walk around the block
- ☐ Read together
- ☐ Prep breakfast
- ☐ Card game or puzzle

## Low-energy

- ☐ Audiobook and blanket
- ☐ Coloring page
- ☐ Warm shower
- ☐ Stretch on the floor
- ☐ Talk while making tea
- ☐ Sort photos for an album

Our two default choices after screens are:

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## TONIGHT

Choose only two defaults for this week. A giant activity list creates another decision when everyone is tired.

# Seven minutes, no lecture

Hold this conversation before recreational screen time begins. The goal is clarity, not agreement with every feeling.

1 min

## Name the problem without blame

"School nights have felt rushed after screens, and our plan has not been clear."

2 min

## State the experiment

"For seven nights, we are trying one rule and seeing what helps."

2 min

## Invite useful input

"Which warning would help: ten minutes and five minutes, or one ten-minute warning?"

1 min

## Show the parking place

"When the timer ends, the device goes here."

1 min

## Choose the next activity

"After that, you can choose A or B."

## Do not ask a fake question

If the endpoint is not negotiable, do not ask, 'Do you think 7:30 is fair?' Offer choice where choice is real: warning style, parking label, or the next activity.

## TONIGHT

**Schedule the meeting before the next recreational session. Put the agreement page on the table.**



# Make the ending visible

Tonight is about predictability, not perfect cooperation.

- 1 Point to the written rule before screen time starts.
- 2 Set the agreed warning and timer.
- 3 Move toward the parking place before the timer ends.
- 4 Use the stop script once. Avoid adding a speech.

## SAY THIS

*"The timer ended. The device parks now. You can be disappointed, and the plan stays the same."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Did the warning happen on time?
- ☐ Was the parking place ready?
- ☐ What was the first point of friction?

## TONIGHT

**Rate the setup, not the child: clear / partly clear / unclear.**

# Separate feeling from boundary

A child can dislike the limit and still understand it.

- 1 Name the feeling in one short sentence.
- 2 Repeat the boundary without defending it.
- 3 Offer the two planned next choices.
- 4 Give space if the child needs a minute.

## SAY THIS

*"You wanted more time. Stopping is hard. The game is done for tonight. Do you want music in the shower or a snack at the table?"*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Did validation become a long negotiation?
- ☐ Were both replacement choices acceptable?
- ☐ What helped the transition move again?

## TONIGHT

**Practice the script once before you need it. Short words are harder to find when you are frustrated.**

# Fix the bridge

If the rule is clear but the transition stalls, improve what happens immediately after.

- 1 Prepare the next activity before the warning.
- 2 Use a concrete first step: shoes on, book open, water running.
- 3 Join for the first two minutes when possible.
- 4 Do not make the replacement a prize that must be earned.

## SAY THIS

*"The tablet is parked. I already put the cards on the table. Pick red or black and deal us five each."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Was there an empty gap after stopping?
- ☐ Did adult connection help?
- ☐ Was the replacement too demanding for that hour?

## TONIGHT

**Choose the lowest-effort bridge that genuinely fits your household.**

# Align the adults

A child should not have to decode two competing plans.

- 1 Agree privately on the endpoint and exceptions.
- 2 Choose who gives the warning and who handles the next activity.
- 3 Use the same short sentence.
- 4 Discuss disagreements after the child is out of earshot.

## SAY THIS

*"We adults changed the plan yesterday, and that was confusing. Tonight the rule is the one on the page."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Did one adult reverse the other?
- ☐ Was the handoff clear?
- ☐ Which adult task needs to be simpler tomorrow?

## TONIGHT

**Write the adult roles beside tonight's rule: warning / parking / next step.**

# Use exceptions without erasing the rule

An exception works when it has a reason, an endpoint, and a return date.

- 1 Name the reason before the usual endpoint.
- 2 State the temporary endpoint.
- 3 Say when the normal plan returns.
- 4 Do not call an unplanned surrender a special occasion.

## SAY THIS

*"Tonight the school livestream ends at 8:15, so the device parks then. Tomorrow we return to 7:30."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Was the exception necessary or convenient?
- ☐ Did the child know when normal resumed?
- ☐ Did the exception create a new problem to solve?

## TONIGHT

**Write one legitimate exception your family may need and the sentence that contains it.**

# Give your child one small job

Tonight you will test whether one small, age-appropriate job makes the handoff easier in your home.

- 1 Keep the endpoint fixed.
- 2 Offer one job: manage the timer, make the parking label, or choose the next activity.
- 3 Let the child check the tracker.
- 4 Name the helpful action instead of calling the child 'good'.

## SAY THIS

*"You noticed the timer and parked it before I reminded you. That made the handoff quicker."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Which job was truly theirs?
- ☐ Did it fit the child's age?
- ☐ What can repeat tomorrow?

## TONIGHT

**Choose one job the child can own without becoming responsible for enforcing the whole plan.**

# Keep, adjust, or replace

The purpose of seven nights is to make the next decision with evidence from your home.

- 1 Review the tracker together for five minutes.
- 2 Name one thing that became clearer.
- 3 Choose one setup change, if needed.
- 4 Write the plan for the next two weeks.

## SAY THIS

*"The parking place worked, but the warning was too late. We are keeping the 7:30 endpoint and moving the first warning to 7:15."*

## NOTICE

- ☐ Was the boundary understandable?
- ☐ Which friction repeated?
- ☐ Did the plan protect necessary screen use?
- ☐ What is the smallest useful adjustment?

## TONIGHT

**Change one variable at a time. If everything changes, you will not know what helped.**

# Before screen time begins

A boundary is easier to hear before the enjoyable thing starts. Use your natural voice. Keep the information; drop any wording that sounds unlike you.

**Introduce the plan**

"We are trying a seven-night school-week plan. Games and videos end at 7:30 and devices charge in the kitchen."

**Clarify necessary use**

"Homework on the laptop can continue. Games, shorts, and shows are done at 7:30."

**Offer warning choice**

"Do you want one ten-minute warning or a ten-minute and five-minute warning?"

**Confirm the stopping point**

"Finish this round. Do not start another one after the warning."

**Name the next step**

"After it parks, choose shower with music or snack and cards."

**TONIGHT**

**Highlight two scripts. Rewrite them in words you would actually say in your kitchen.**



# When time is almost up

Warnings work when they contain useful information. Repeating the warning every minute turns it into background noise.

## Ten minutes

"Ten minutes left. Check where you can stop or save."

## Five minutes

"Five minutes. This is the last round / episode section / video."

## Timer rings

"Time. Save, close, and park it."

## Child says, 'One more'

"I hear you. Starting another one takes us past the plan."

## Online teammates are involved

"Tell them this is your last round. We will keep the agreed endpoint."

## TONIGHT

**Match the warning to the content. A round needs a different stopping cue from a short video feed.**

# When pushback arrives

Do not try to win the feeling. Hold the limit, protect safety, and use fewer words as emotions rise.

**'That's not fair'**

"You do not think it is fair. The school-night plan stays at 7:30."

**'Everyone else can'**

"Other families have other plans. This is ours for seven nights."

**Refusal to hand it over**

"I will keep the device safe while you take a minute. We can talk when voices are lower."

**Adult starts to lecture**

"I am going to stop talking now. The rule is on the page."

**After a hard handoff**

"That was rough. We will repair what needs repairing and try the same clear plan tomorrow."

If anyone may be hurt or property may be damaged, prioritize safety over completing the script. Step back, reduce stimulation, and seek appropriate support when needed.

**TONIGHT**

**Pick the shortest sentence that you can still say calmly.**

# Exceptions, mistakes, and repair

Consistency does not mean pretending adults never make mistakes. Clear repair protects trust better than a defensive explanation.

## Adult forgot the warning

"I missed the warning. That made the ending abrupt. You get five minutes to save, then it parks."

## Adult changed the rule midstream

"I changed the plan while you were using it. That was confusing. Tonight we use the original endpoint."

## Necessary use runs late

"The assignment took longer. When it is submitted, the laptop parks. Recreational apps stay closed."

## Special event

"Tonight is different because of the family call. It ends at 8:00. Normal time returns tomorrow."

## Morning repair

"Last night got louder than I wanted. I am sorry for yelling. The boundary still matters, and tonight I will give the warning on time."

## TONIGHT

**Repair your part without requiring the child to apologize first.**

# A routine they can see

Younger school-age children often need fewer steps, a visible sequence, and adult help starting the next activity.

|   | STEP           | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE                                    |
|---|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Warning        | Adult points to timer and routine card.               |
| 2 | Save and close | Child finishes the agreed stopping point.             |
| 3 | Park           | Device goes to the same charging place.               |
| 4 | Connect        | Two minutes with an adult: hug, snack, or short chat. |
| 5 | Next           | Child chooses one of two prepared activities.         |

Our picture or symbol for 'park':

Our two next choices:

The adult who starts the bridge:

TONIGHT

Draw one simple icon beside each step. Let the child point to what comes next.

# A routine they can take on step by step

Older children can take more responsibility for saving, setting a timer, and checking the plan. Adults still own the boundary and safety decisions.

|   | STEP  | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE                                           |
|---|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Plan  | Child names a realistic stopping point before starting.      |
| 2 | Warn  | Timer gives the agreed cue; adult avoids repeated reminders. |
| 3 | Close | Child saves progress and logs out if needed.                 |
| 4 | Park  | Device charges outside the sleep space when appropriate.     |
| 5 | Reset | Child picks the next task or activity from the plan.         |

The responsibility I can hand over:

The responsibility the adult keeps:

How we handle online teammates:

TONIGHT  
Ask, 'Which part can you manage without me reminding you?' Keep the answer small and observable.

# Build a device parking station

A visible home for devices ends the question, 'Where does it go?' Choose a practical location, not a symbolic punishment shelf.

- |                                                |                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Near power outlets    | <input type="checkbox"/> Outside bedrooms when appropriate                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Visible to adults     | <input type="checkbox"/> Safe from spills                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Enough labeled spaces | <input type="checkbox"/> Does not block necessary calls or accessibility tools |

Our parking station will be:

---

## LABELS

|        |                    |         |
|--------|--------------------|---------|
| Adult  | Child 1            | Child 2 |
| Tablet | Console controller | Other   |

### Adults count

If the family rule protects dinner or bedtime, decide what adult devices do during that same window. Modeling does not require identical needs; it requires an honest plan.

## TONIGHT

**Set up the station before announcing the rule. Empty promises are harder to follow than visible systems.**

# Our seven-night plan

The school nights included are

---

Recreational screens covered by the plan are

---

Necessary uses that remain available are

---

Our endpoint is

---

Our warnings are

---

Devices park or charge at

---

After screens, the two default choices are

---

Adults will support the plan by

---

If tonight is difficult, tomorrow we will

---

\_\_\_\_\_  
Caregiver

\_\_\_\_\_  
Caregiver

\_\_\_\_\_  
Child

\_\_\_\_\_  
Child

Signing means, 'We understand the plan.' It does not require everyone to enjoy every part of it.

**TONIGHT**

**Post the agreement where the transition happens. A plan hidden in a drawer cannot carry the boundary for you.**

# Track the setup, not obedience

Use quick marks. The goal is to notice what makes the plan easier to follow, not to grade your child.

| Night | Warning on time? | Endpoint clear? | Bridge ready? | What helped / what caught us |
|-------|------------------|-----------------|---------------|------------------------------|
| 1     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 2     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 3     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 4     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 5     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 6     |                  |                 |               |                              |
| 7     |                  |                 |               |                              |

The part to keep:

The repeated friction:

One setup change for next week:

TONIGHT  
Complete the row after the transition, not during it.



# Low-friction choices for real school nights

These are bridges, not enrichment projects. Pick what your family will actually use on a tired Tuesday.

## Move

- ☐ Hallway balloon volley
- ☐ Ten wall pushes
- ☐ Walk the dog
- ☐ One-song freeze dance
- ☐ Stretch cards
- ☐ Stair count challenge

## Make

- ☐ Tiny comic
- ☐ Paper airplane test
- ☐ Build a snack face
- ☐ One-photo scavenger list
- ☐ Lego copy challenge
- ☐ Tomorrow's lunch note

## Settle

- ☐ Audiobook
- ☐ Read side by side
- ☐ Warm drink
- ☐ Puzzle tray
- ☐ Shower playlist
- ☐ Three good questions

Put a star beside three choices that require no shopping or preparation.

## TONIGHT

Prepare one object before screen time ends: cards on the table, towel out, book open, shoes by the door.

# Change the setup before you change the promise

Keep the boundary stable long enough to learn. Use the first repeated problem you see.

| WHAT YOU SEE                         | CHECK FIRST                                           | TRY FOR TWO NIGHTS                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The ending feels explosive           | Warning may be late or the stopping point may be poor | Move the first warning earlier; agree on save/round endpoint before play               |
| The child keeps starting new content | The content has no natural end                        | Use a clock endpoint and block autoplay/new rounds after the warning                   |
| Homework becomes a loophole          | Necessary and recreational use are mixed              | Name the assignment and close unrelated apps before starting                           |
| Adults give different answers        | The adult plan is unresolved                          | Pause the experiment for one adult conversation, then relaunch one rule                |
| The next task never starts           | The bridge is too vague or demanding                  | Prepare the first tiny step and join for two minutes                                   |
| The plan works only with threats     | Consequences are doing all the work                   | Shorten the rule, improve predictability, and review whether the endpoint is realistic |

TONIGHT

Choose one row. Test one adjustment for two nights before adding another.

# Repair without erasing the boundary

A reset does not require pretending the night went well. It asks each person to own what belongs to them and return to a workable plan.

- 1

**Regulate first**

Wait until voices and bodies are steadier. Repair is not effective while the conflict is still peaking.
- 2

**Name your part**

I yelled. I changed the rule. I forgot the warning. Be specific and stop there.
- 3

**Restate the plan**

An apology for delivery is not an apology for having a boundary.
- 4

**Fix the setup**

Move the timer, prepare the bridge, simplify the wording, or align the adults.
- 5

**Try again**

The next opportunity is the next school night, not a distant fresh start.

*"Last night got louder than I wanted. I am sorry for yelling. The 7:30 plan still matters. Tonight I will give the warning earlier and have the snack ready."*

## TONIGHT

**Write the repair sentence you may need. Keeping it ready makes defensiveness less likely.**

# Know when to get more support

A printable plan cannot carry every family situation. Seek qualified support when screen-related conflict is persistent, severe, or connected to broader concerns.

- ☐ Safety is at risk, including threats, violence, self-harm, exploitation, or unsafe online contact.
- ☐ Screen use repeatedly displaces eating, school attendance, hygiene, sleep opportunity, movement, or in-person relationships.
- ☐ The child shows severe distress that does not settle after transitions or appears across several parts of daily life.
- ☐ A device is essential for disability access, health monitoring, communication, or learning and the plan needs professional adaptation.
- ☐ Caregiver conflict makes consistent implementation impossible or unsafe.

## Where to begin

Start with your child's pediatrician or primary-care clinician, school support team, or a licensed child and family mental-health professional. For immediate danger, use local emergency services.

## TONIGHT

**Write the name and contact information of the first support person you would call.**

# Built for action, grounded in family media planning

This toolkit translates broadly accepted family-media principles into a short planning workflow. It is not a substitute for individualized professional advice.

## American Academy of Pediatrics

How to Make a Family Media Plan

[healthychildren.org/English/family-life/Media/Pages/How-to-Make-a-Family-Media-Use-Plan.aspx](https://healthychildren.org/English/family-life/Media/Pages/How-to-Make-a-Family-Media-Use-Plan.aspx)

## American Academy of Pediatrics

A Child-Friendly Digital World: new media recommendations

[healthychildren.org/English/news/Pages/creating-a-child-friendly-digital-world-AAP-releases-new-media-recommendations.aspx](https://healthychildren.org/English/news/Pages/creating-a-child-friendly-digital-world-AAP-releases-new-media-recommendations.aspx)

## Pew Research Center

How Parents Manage Screen Time for Kids (2025 survey)

[pewresearch.org/internet/2025/10/08/how-parents-manage-screen-time-for-kids/](https://pewresearch.org/internet/2025/10/08/how-parents-manage-screen-time-for-kids/)

## Singapore Ministry of Digital Development and Information

Digital Parenting Survey (2025)

[mddi.gov.sg/newsroom/mddi-study-shows-most-parents-guide-childrens-digital-use-but-would-like-more-support/](https://mddi.gov.sg/newsroom/mddi-study-shows-most-parents-guide-childrens-digital-use-but-would-like-more-support/)

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**Your next step is small: choose one boundary, prepare one bridge, and make tonight clearer than yesterday.**